

House Appropriations Committee Research Report for Capiro

Prepared for Neo Martinez, CTO ? Capiro

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

This report provides a comprehensive analysis of the House Appropriations Committee (HAC) process, submission types, deadlines, and requirements ? with specific recommendations for Capiro's workflow automation platform. The HAC controls all discretionary federal spending (~23% of the federal budget), making it one of the two critical venues (alongside the NDAA authorization process) where government affairs professionals operate.

Capiro already supports NDAA authorization requests. Adding HAC appropriations support would give users coverage of both sides of the congressional funding equation ? authorization (telling DoD what to do) and appropriations (giving DoD the money to do it).

SECTION 1: HOW HOUSE APPROPRIATIONS WORKS

Constitutional Foundation

Authorization vs. Appropriation ? The Two-Step Process

- 1. Authorization (what Capiro already supports via NDAA): Other committees (like Armed Services) establish, continue, or alter programs. The NDAA authorizes the Navy to create a program.
- 2. Appropriation (what this report covers): The Appropriations Committee decides how much money each authorized program receives. Without appropriations, an authorized program has no funding.

Key insight for Capiro: Most lobbyist firms submit BOTH an authorization request (NDAA) and a parallel appropriations request for the same program. Capiro should make it easy to create paired submissions.

Committee Structure

- 12 Subcommittees, each covering a different area of government:

#	Subcommittee	Key Jurisdiction	Contact Email
2	Commerce, Justice, Science	DOJ, NASA, NOAA, NSF, Census	CJS.MemberRequests@mail.house.gov
4	Energy & Water Development	DOE, Army Corps, NRC	EW.MemberRequests@mail.house.gov
6	Homeland Security	DHS, CBP, ICE, FEMA, Coast Guard	HS.MemberRequests@mail.house.gov
8	Labor, HHS, Education	DOL, HHS, NIH, CDC, Dept of Ed	LH.MemberRequests@mail.house.gov
10	Military Construction, VA	MilCon, VA, Arlington Cemetery	MC.MemberRequests@mail.house.gov
12	Transportation, HUD	DOT, HUD, FAA, Amtrak	TH.MemberRequests@mail.house.gov

The Annual Appropriations Process (Timeline)

1. First Monday in February: President's Budget Request (PBR) submitted
3. February?March: Budget and oversight hearings ? agency leaders defend funding
5. April?May: Subcommittee markups ? bills drafted within 302(b) allocations
7. Summer?Fall: House floor debate, Senate action, conference

Types of Appropriations Measures

1. Regular Appropriations: 12 annual spending bills (the primary vehicle)
3. Supplemental Appropriations: Additional funding for emergencies/shortfalls mid-year

SECTION 2: SUBMISSION TYPES AND REQUIREMENTS

Overview

2.1 Programmatic Requests

What: A request to fund a specific program or activity at a specified dollar level in the appropriations bill.

This is the appropriations equivalent of the NDAA authorization request Capiro already supports.

Required Information (based on FY27 guidance and standard practice):

- Subcommittee (must match the program's jurisdiction)
- Program Element (PE) or Budget Activity number
- President's Budget Request level for the same line
- Justification narrative (why the increase is needed)

Deadlines vary by subcommittee ? see Section 3 below.

2.2 Language Requests

What: A request to include specific bill language or report language that does NOT direct funding to a particular entity, but encourages, urges, or directs some type of action.

Two sub-types:

- Report Language: Goes into the committee report accompanying the bill. Carries persuasive weight but is not legally binding. Used to express congressional intent, direct studies, require reports, etc.

Required Information:

- Subcommittee
- Exact proposed language text

- Relevant program/agency context

2.3 Community Project Funding (CPF) Requests (aka Earmarks)

What: Requests to fund specific projects in a Member's district/state. These are the modern version of earmarks, brought back in 2021 with strict transparency rules.

Key Rules:

- Federal Nexus Required: Projects must have a clear connection to federal programs/policies
- Financial Disclosure: Members must certify they have no financial interest
- No For-Profit Recipients: For most subcommittees, CPF funds cannot go to for-profit entities

Required Information:

- Recipient entity (must be eligible non-profit, government, or educational institution)
- Dollar amount requested
- Federal nexus statement
- Community support documentation

Not applicable for: Defense, Financial Services, Legislative Branch, National Security/State (these subcommittees do not accept CPF)

SECTION 3: FY27 DEADLINES BY SUBCOMMITTEE

Subcommittee	Programmatic/Language Deadline	CPF Deadline	CPF Public Posting Deadline
Commerce/Justice/Science	March 13, 2026, 6:00 PM	March 19, 2026, 6:00 PM	March 27, 2026, 6:00 PM
Energy & Water	March 20, 2026, 6:00 PM	March 20, 2026, 6:00 PM	April 17, 2026, 6:00 PM
Homeland Security	March 20, 2026, 6:00 PM	March 20, 2026, 6:00 PM	April 17, 2026, 6:00 PM
Labor/HHS/Education	March 27, 2026, 6:00 PM	March 27, 2026, 6:00 PM	April 17, 2026, 6:00 PM
MilCon/VA	March 13, 2026, 6:00 PM	March 13, 2026, 6:00 PM	March 27, 2026, 6:00 PM
Transportation/HUD	March 27, 2026, 6:00 PM	March 27, 2026, 6:00 PM	April 17, 2026, 6:00 PM

SECTION 4: DEFENSE SUBCOMMITTEE ? DEEP DIVE

Since Capiro's NDAA features focus on defense, the Defense Appropriations Subcommittee is the most relevant:

Jurisdiction

- Departments of Army, Navy (including Marine Corps), Air Force (including Space Force)
- Central Intelligence Agency

Defense Programmatic Request Fields (aligns closely with NDAA authorization)

- Appropriation account (RDT&E, Procurement, O&M, etc.)
- Line Item Number
- Requested funding level
- Program description and justification

Key Difference from NDAA

- Appropriations requests go to HAC Defense Subcommittee members ? Appropriations Committee

SECTION 5: FY27 MARKUP SCHEDULE (Current as of May 2026)

The Committee is actively marking up FY27 bills:

Date	Event
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May 15, 2026	Energy & Water subcommittee markup
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May 21, 2026	Subcommittee: Interior + Transportation/HUD
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June 4, 2026	Full Committee: Transportation/HUD
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SECTION 6: FEATURE RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CAPIRO

Priority 1: Appropriations Request Template (Parallel to NDAA)

- Nearly every NDAA request should have a companion appropriations request
- Add a "Create Companion Appropriations Request" button on the NDAA form

Priority 2: Language Request Template

- Toggle between Bill Language and Report Language
- Justification field
- Reference to existing report language examples (link to prior year reports)

Priority 3: Community Project Funding (CPF) Template

- All required fields (project name, recipient, location, amount, federal nexus)
- Per-member project count tracker (max 20)

- Eligible account checker (flag if account doesn't accept CPF)

Priority 4: Deadline Tracker / Calendar

- Automatically show upcoming HAC and SASC submission deadlines
- Push notifications as deadlines approach

Priority 5: Paired Submission Tracker

- Link NDAA requests to their companion appropriations requests
- Alert if one side is submitted but not the other

Priority 6: Subcommittee Contact Intelligence

- Which Members sit on which Appropriations subcommittees
- Historical voting patterns on relevant bills

Priority 7: White Paper / One-Pager Generator

- Generate 1-2 page program white papers from the form data
- Include program description, funding justification, and impact metrics

Priority 8: Submission Portal Integration

- The HAC has an electronic submission portal
 - Pre-fill data in the correct format for copy/paste into the portal
 - Store confirmation/receipt info

Priority 9: Historical Data & Comparison

- Show FY2026 enacted funding levels as reference
- AI-powered suggestions based on historical success patterns

Priority 10: Senate Appropriations Support

- The Senate Appropriations Committee (SAC) has a parallel process
- Many firms submit to both chambers simultaneously

SECTION 7: KEY RESOURCES AND LINKS

Resource URL

FY27 Member Request Guidance <https://appropriations.house.gov/fy27-information/fy27-member-requests-guidance>

FY27 Bill Text and Reports <https://appropriations.house.gov/fy27-information/fy27-bill-text-and-reports>

FY27 Amendment Tracker <https://appropriations.house.gov/fy27-information/fy27-amendment-tracker>

Electronic Submission Portal Referenced in guidance (link available on guidance page)

Financial Disclosure Templates Referenced in guidance (link available on guidance page)

FY2026 CPF Examples Referenced in guidance (for reference)

SECTION 8: SUMMARY OF IMMEDIATE ACTION ITEMS

1. Now: Build an "Appropriations Programmatic Request" template in the workflow catalog (mirrors NDAA but for HAC). This is the lowest-hanging fruit.
2. Next: Add "Language Request" template (bill/report language). Very common submission type.
3. Soon: Add deadline tracking with the FY27 dates hardcoded, then make it dynamic for future years.
4. Medium-term: Build the "Create Companion Request" feature linking NDAA ? Appropriations workflows.
5. Longer-term: CPF template, white paper generator, Senate appropriations support.

Report compiled from live research of appropriations.house.gov on May 16, 2026.